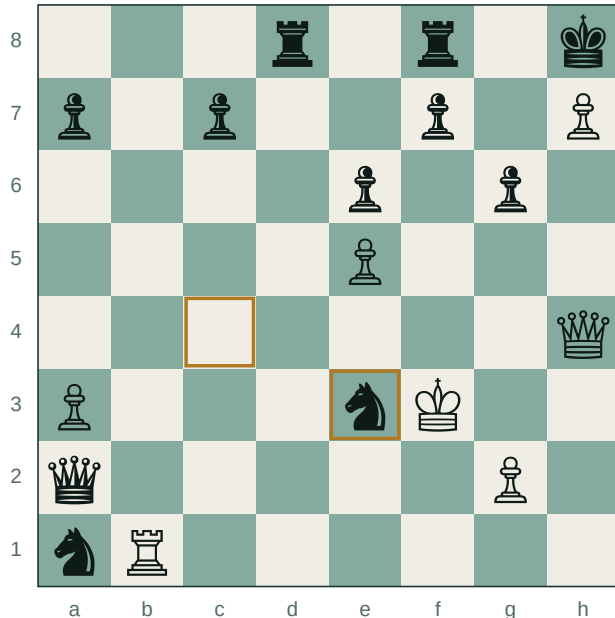


Exposed-king tactics: White, move 27

Exposed-king tactics

White to move



Previous move: 26...Nxe3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

27. Qf6+ Kxh7 28. Rh1+ Kg8 29. Rh8#

27.Qf6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From f6 it attacks king on h8 and rook on d8. Recorded reply: **27...Kxh7**.

28.Rh1+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From h1 it attacks king on h7 and knight on a1. Recorded reply: **28...Kg8**.

29.Rh8# Mate: rook on h8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An exposed king gives the attacker checks and access to nearby squares. Coordinate pieces so the checks drive it into a worse net rather than toward safety.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on h8. Geometrically undefended: knight on e3 and queen on a2. Check for tactical protection.